

Across Borders: What the Numbers Hide

跨越边界：数字隐藏了什么

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The numbers hid a **desert** of small failures. **Hardly** anyone had received the **training** they were promised, and a **gift** of two tickets was given **twice** to the same family. “I may be wrong, perhaps,” Aisha said, “but **an** survey that only counts participants will always be sure of itself.” I own the mistake, she added, and the room went quiet.

Primarily the report measured **sponsorship**, and the **sponsorship** was **dirty** money from a **dusty** road fund. “**An incredible friendship** is worth more than **warmth** from a machine,” Maya wrote. “We are **seemingly** measuring **geography** when we are actually measuring power.” **Owing to** the **frosty** reception, the numbers went into the appendix, and the appendix went **moldy** in the damp.

The **excessive intent** behind the count was not hidden from the **biochemist** who joined them for a month. “You cannot **compute holiness**,” she said, “and a **repetitive** figure will **overtake** the truth if you let it.” **Downward** pressure on the budget followed; the **severity** of it was overwhelming, and the mood in the office turned **gloomy**.

Lastly, the **rarity** of the good numbers made them even more dangerous. “**An eternal** average is a lie with a long life,” the old man said. “Do not let them **ridicule** the **messy** part, and do not **exaggerate** the clean one.” A **speechless** trainee sympathized and said nothing; the **perilous** part was the silence.

They decided to **globalize** nothing and to publish a second sheet: one for the figures and one for the **frosty** mornings. It was not a dramatic return, but it was a return, and they were **desirous** of one thing only: that the report be readable by the people it described. Maybe it would be; perhaps it would not. Across the **pavement**, the **training** had been offered to anyone who wished to **participate**, and **hardly** anyone had. “We hope they will not **depart** before the vote,” the **biochemist** said, “and we hope they will not **obey** a **heaven** made of averages.” Still, the man who had come back from the **desert** said the mood was **overwhelmingly** better than the year before, and the figures that had been thrown away were carried back into the room. They would not lose the argument; it was over before the second sheet was printed.

中文翻译

这些数字掩盖了一片由小失败组成的沙漠。几乎没有一个人得到过承诺过的培训，而一份两张票的礼物被同一家人拿走了两次。“我也许错了，或许吧，”艾莎说，“但一项只统计参与者的调查，总会对自己充满确信。”她补充说，这个错误算我的——屋里安静下来。

这份报告主要衡量的是赞助，而赞助来自一笔走漏到肮脏道路基金的钱。“一段难以置信的友谊比机器带来的温暖更值钱，”曼雅写道，“我们表面上在测量地理，实际上却在测量权力。”由于那次冷淡的接待，数字被放进了附录，而附录在潮湿中发霉了。

这次计数背后过度的意图，没能瞒过和他们共事一个月的生物化学家。“你无法计算神圣，”她说，“而一个重复的数字，只要你放任它，就会超越真相。”预算随之承受向下的压力；其严酷程度是压倒性的，办公室里的气氛变得阴郁。

最后，那些好数字的罕见反而使它们更危险。“一个永恒的均值，是一条长寿的谎言，”老人说。“不要让他们嘲弄混乱的那部分，也不要夸大干净的那部分。”一位说不出话的实习生表示同情，却什么也没说；危险的部分正是这份沉默。

他们决定不把任何东西全球化，而是发布第二张纸：一张写给数字，一张写给那些结霜的早晨。这不是一次戏剧性的回归，但它是一次回归；他们只渴望一件事：让这份报告能被它所描述的人读懂。也许能，也许不能。人行道对面，那项培训向任何愿意参加的人开放，而几乎没有人参加。“我们希望他们不要在表决之前离开，”那位生物化学家说，“也希望他们不要去服从一个由平均数造出来的天堂。”尽管如此，那位从沙漠回来的人说，气氛比前一年好了太多，而那些被扔掉的数字被重新搬回了屋里。他们不会输掉这场论证；在第二张纸印出来之前，它就已经结束了。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
an æn POS: art	art. 一 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an associate degree in nursing
training ˈtreɪnɪŋ POS: n	n. 训练, 培养; [医] 训练 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. activity leading to skilled behavior
hardly ˈhɑːdli POS: adv	adv. 刚刚, 几乎不, 勉强是 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. almost not
gift ɡɪft POS: n	n. 礼物, 赠予, 天才; vt. 赋予 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something acquired without compensation
twice twais POS: adv	adv. 两次, 两倍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. two times
participate pɑːˈtɪsɪpeɪt POS: vi	vi. 参加, 分享, 参与, 带有; vt. 分享, 分担 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. share in something
primarily ˈpraɪməriili POS: adv	adv. 主要地, 首先地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. of primary import
desert ˈdezət, dɪˈsɜ:t POS: n	n. 沙漠, 应得的赏罚, 功劳; a. 沙漠的, 不毛的; vt. 放弃, 遗弃, 擅离; vi. 逃掉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. arid land with little or no vegetation; v. leave behind
heaven ˈhevɪn POS: n	n. 天堂, 上帝, 天空 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the abode of God and the angels
dirty ˈdɜ:ti POS: a	a. 肮脏的, 卑鄙的; vt. 弄脏; vi. 变脏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make soiled, filthy, or dirty; a. soiled or likely to soil with dirt or grime; a. (of behavior or especially...
incredible ɪnˈkredəbl POS: a	a. 难以置信的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. beyond belief or understanding
friendship ˈfrendʃɪp POS: n	n. 友谊, 友爱, 友善 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being friends (or friendly)
warmth wɜ:mθ POS: n	n. 温暖, 温情, 暖和, 激动, 生气 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of having a moderate degree of heat
seemingly ˈsi:mɪŋli POS: adv	adv. 看来似乎, 表面上看来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r from appearances alone
pavement ˈpeɪvmənt POS: n	n. 路面, 人行道, 铺面路, 铺路材料 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the paved surface of a thoroughfare
excessive ɪkˈsesɪv POS: a	a. 过度的, 过多的, 极端的; [法] 过度的, 过分的, 额外的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. beyond normal limits; s. unrestrained, especially with regard to feelings
intent ɪnˈtent POS: n	n. 意图, 含义, 故意; a. 专心的, 决心的, 热心的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the intended meaning of a communication
geography dʒɪˈɡræfi POS: n	n. 地理学, 地理; [医] 地理 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. study of the earth's surface; includes people's responses to topography and climate and soil and vegetation
depart dɪˈpɑ:t POS: vi	vi. 离开, 出发, 背离, 违反, 去世 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. leave; v. go away or leave
obey əˈbei POS: vt	vt. 服从, 遵从, 顺从; vi. 服从 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be obedient to
sponsorship ˈsponsəʃɪp POS: n	n. 发起, 倡议, 主办, 保证人的地位, 教父的地位, 教母的地位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of sponsoring (either officially or financially)
dusty ˈdʌsti POS: a	a. 灰尘多的, 无聊的, 含糊的, 粉末状的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. covered with a layer of dust
eternal ɪˈtɜ:nl POS: a	a. 永恒的, 永远的, 不灭的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s continuing forever or indefinitely; s tiresomely long; seemingly without end
exaggerate ɪɡˈzædʒəreɪt POS: v	v. 夸大, 夸张 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v to enlarge beyond bounds or the truth; v do something to an excessive degree

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
overtake ˌəʊvə'teɪk POS: vt	vt. 赶上, 突然降临于, 压倒, 代替 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. catch up with and possibly overtake
messy 'mesi POS: a	a. 散乱的, 污秽的, 麻烦的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. dirty and disorderly
overwhelmingly ˌəʊvə'hwelmɪŋli POS: adv	adv. 压倒性地, 不可抵抗地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. incapable of being resisted
gloomy 'glu:mi POS: a	a. 抑沉的, 忧闷的, 黑暗的, 悲观的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. filled with melancholy and despondency
severity si'verɪti POS: n	n. 严格, 朴素, 激烈 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. excessive sternness
compute kəm'pjʊ:t POS: v	v. 计算, 估算; n. 计算, 估算 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v make a mathematical calculation or computation
downward 'daʊnwəd POS: a	a. 向下的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. on or toward a surface regarded as a base
repetitive ri'petɪtɪv POS: a	a. 重复的, 反复性的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by repetition
lastly 'lɑ:stli POS: adv	adv. 最后, 终于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r the item at the end
rarity 'reərəti POS: n	n. 稀罕, 罕有, 珍奇, 稀薄 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. noteworthy scarcity; n. a rarified quality
ridicule 'rɪdɪkjʊ:l POS: n	n. 嘲笑, 愚弄, 笑柄; vt. 嘲笑, 嘲弄, 愚弄 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. language or behavior intended to mock or humiliate; v. subject to laughter or ridicule
sympathize 'sɪmpəθaɪz POS: vi	vi. 同情, 怜悯, 同意, 体谅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. share the feelings of; understand the sentiments of; v. be understanding of
perilous 'perɪləs POS: a	a. 危险的, 濒临毁灭的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. fraught with danger
speechless 'spi:tʃlɪs POS: a	a. 不会说话的, 哑的, 说不出话的, 无言的, 非言语所能表达的, (非正式) 烂醉的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. temporarily incapable of speaking
frosty 'froʊsti POS: a	a. 霜冻的, 严寒的, 冷淡的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. covered with frost
holiness 'həʊlɪnɪs POS: n	n. 神圣; 圣座 (大写, 对教宗等的尊称) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being holy
moldy 'məʊldi POS: a	a. 发霉的, 腐臭的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. covered with or smelling of mold
biochemist ˌbaɪəʊ'kemɪst POS: n	n. 生物化学家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone with special training in biochemistry
globalize 'gləʊbəlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使全球化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make world-wide in scope or application
desirous dɪ'zaɪərəs POS: a	a. 想要的, 想望的, 渴望的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or expressing desire for something
owing to phonetic unavailable POS: review required	由于..., 因为... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.